

imported goods, to make them more expensive. Some economists disagree with this kind of “protectionism,” as it is called. They argue that there should be free international trade without government restrictions.



DAVID RICARDO (1772–1823)

Born in London, Ricardo, like his father, was a stockbroker. After making a fortune buying government bonds before the Battle of Waterloo (1815), he became a politician. One of the foremost classical economists, he wrote *On the Principles of Political Economy and Taxation* in 1817.



The Silk Road was a trade route linking China, India, Arabia, and Europe for more than 1,500 years.

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